

COMIC BOOK

Aghori Book 01

★★★★☆ | In a country like ours with an immensely rich and diverse culture spread across its lands, there is no dearth of inspiration or sources to find stories to tell. Among these stories, there's a vast majority that defies the laws of reality – tales of celestial beings, divine beauties, immortality, demons, the undead, and more. Aghori is a series that brings these elements together in a story that is not only enrapturing but also gritty and unapologetic in its depictions. As the self-explanatory title shows, this story revolves around taking the mysticism associated with the group of ascetic Shaiva sadhus and their post-mortem rituals and turning it into a riveting fantasy story. Aghori is a gritty, mature title that does not shy from exploring uncharted territory to tell its story. You'd need to have a stomach for violence and gore to be on board with this story. On the other hand, this is exactly what makes it such a refreshing read compared to the usual superhero and mythology fare that we've seen in the Indian comic book scene. We don't mean to say that we've anything against those titles – but Aghori's unique premise, tying in the occult side of mythology, makes it more relatable as compared to the retelling of mythological stories that a lot of us already know of. Another reason that makes it a good hook from the get-go is that the writers have taken a leap of faith and given the protagonist a dark origin, one whose guilt is pretty evident in the way Vira carries himself in the story. If you've enjoyed TV shows like Penny Dreadful, and characters such as John Constantine, don't miss this.



COMIC BOOK

Ravanayan Volume 1

★★★★☆ | Ravanayan is a brilliant retelling of the Ramayana that has been rarely explored in comic books – a version where Ravana is actually the main protagonist. Born from a sage father and rakshasi mother, it explores an arc where Ravana is fighting his internal conflicts and searching for his destiny. Even though he discovers that his path to achieving his fate will mean completely disregarding all his wisdom and righteous self, he accepts it wholeheartedly. The first volume (packing three issues) does depict a good progression from his humble beginnings as a wise individual in his childhood to the point where he turns into a ruthless monster. It's indeed fascinating to realise that with a different perspective, there could be so much potential to tell a new story. The answer to the bigger question on whether he's ultimately good or evil will definitely vary from reader-to-reader. Ravanayan doesn't change the final outcome of Ravana's loss. Rather, it tries to explore the reasons behind all his actions that not only led to his downfall but the destruction of his entire kingdom. The fascinating story is about his motivations and beliefs.



UP AND COMING

COMIC BOOK

Silver Surfer Annual #1



The untold story of the Silver Surfer explores his dark and tragic past as the new Herald of the Devourer of Worlds.

How far will he go to feed his master's hunger?

Release date: September 5, 2018.

TV SHOW

Iron Fist Season 2



The first teaser of Iron Fist's second season teased Danny Rand wearing the classic Iron Fist costume with

the yellow mask battling against another fighter to become K'un Lun's champion.

Release date: September 7, 2018.

MOVIE

The Predator



A new chapter in the Predator story is going to unfold as they are not only bigger but deadlier this time having

genetically upgraded themselves. Will the arrival of these enhanced Predators end the human race?

Release date: September 14, 2018.